

Dear Partners

As 2025 comes to an end, I extend my sincere thanks for your continued partnership, professionalism, and trust in the St. Kitts and Nevis Citizenship Programme. This year marked a defining chapter—one shaped by reform, renewed purpose, and strengthened credibility. None of these accomplishments would have been possible without your ongoing support.



A Year of Progress and Reform

The year began on a strong footing with recognition from the International Monetary Fund for the Government's progress in transparency, sustainability, and compliance. This acknowledgment set the tone for one of the most ambitious reform periods in the Programme's history. Throughout 2025, we strengthened governance, modernised systems, elevated service standards, and reinforced the global credibility for which St. Kitts and Nevis is known.

At the heart of this transformation is our unwavering commitment to integrity, national security, transparency, and international cooperation. These principles continue to guide the evolution of the Programme.

Genuine Link and Integration Requirement

A cornerstone of the redesigned framework is the introduction of a mandatory genuine-link requirement. Citizenship is now granted based on a demonstrable, substantive, and ongoing connection to the Federation. This includes structured physical presence and residency, meaningful economic activity such as business establishment and job creation, productive investment aligned with national priorities, and long-term social, cultural, philanthropic, or national development engagement.

The Programme will include an Innovation Pathway for individuals who establish an active, long-term partnership with St. Kitts and Nevis. This includes innovation-driven business, research, technology, skills transfer, or technology projects that contribute towards economic diversification.

Enhanced post-naturalisation obligations further reinforce accountability and integration.

In parallel, we continue to maintain full control over passport issuance. All St. Kitts and Nevis passports are issued exclusively by the Government and delivered only through official embassies and consulates. No intermediaries or third parties are involved, ensuring maximum security, traceability, and integrity.

Transition from Contribution-Based Pathways

Looking ahead to 2026, the Programme will commence its transition away from contribution-based pathways. In place of passive financial contributions, the Programme will focus on residency- and participation-based routes that encourage meaningful engagement and long-term connection with the country.

This evolution reflects international best practice and mirrors the standards applied in leading permanent residency and naturalisation frameworks across the European Union, the United Kingdom, and the United States, reinforcing the Programme's commitment to credibility, sustainability, and global confidence.



Key Milestones in 2025

BEYOND STRUCTURAL REFORM, 2025 DELIVERED SEVERAL IMPORTANT ACHIEVEMENTS:

- Establishment of the **Office of the Chairman** to strengthen strategic oversight.
- Launch of the **Saturn Platform**, enabling real-time digital applications, biometrics, and blockchain-enhanced due diligence that cross-references applicants against international watchlists before processing.
- Recognition at the **Caribbean Investment Summit** receiving awards for efficiency and heritage preservation.
- Hosting of the second **Investment Gateway Summit** with global participation.
- Introduction of **CARICOM's first Electronic Travel Authorisation system**.
- Implementation of **enhanced AML/CTF protocols** for mandatory interviews, and fingerprinting, alongside regional **recognition for best AML/CTF practice**.
- Passage of new rules reinforcing **authentic residency** and **Programme credibility**.
- Signing of the **Eastern Caribbean CBI Regulatory Framework**, advancing regional harmonisation.
- A **169% increase in applications**, accompanied by proportionally higher rejection rates—demonstrating tightened due diligence standards.
- Announcement of a **US\$10 million Affordable Housing Project** under the Public Benefit Option, supported by rigorous financial reporting and ring-fenced funds.
- Becoming the first Programme in the Caribbean to adopt **blockchain-verified due diligence certification**.
- Launching the first cohort of the **Micro and Small Business Grant Programme**, providing EC\$360,000 to 36 entrepreneurs.



TOGETHER, THESE MILESTONES TELL A SINGLE STORY:

A programme evolving with purpose, supported by partners committed to its long-term success.



Looking Ahead:

OUR AGENDA FOR 2026 IS GUIDED BY FOUR STRATEGIC PRIORITIES:

1. Residency Integration

Rolling out the residency pathway in a seamless and meaningful way, with strict enforcement of authentic residency requirements and transparent reporting on refusals and revocations.

2. Regional Regulatory Harmonisation

Working closely with regional partners and regulators to uphold shared standards.

3. Investment Gateway Summit 2026

We continue to reinforce collaboration and nation building through our flagship annual event. Dates to be announced shortly



Introducing Priority One

In 2026, we will also launch Priority One, a concierge and civic integration service designed to support investors well beyond approval. This service reflects our belief that citizenship marks the beginning of a long-term relationship, not the end of a transaction. Priority One will guide new citizens in meeting genuine-link requirements through ongoing legal, fiscal, and civic compliance.



Continuing Digital Transformation

Phase II of our digital modernisation will deliver improved communication touchpoints, more intuitive agent dashboards, transparent case tracking, and greater automation to support faster outcomes. We remain equally committed to enhancing service delivery through clearer updates, improved response times, and deeper engagement with our partners.

Closing Reflections

Saint Kitts and Nevis has long been a pioneer in citizenship policy. Today, that legacy is reflected in leadership on integrity, robust regulation, and long-term national value, underpinned by continuous cooperation, transparency, and a shared commitment to the highest standards.

Thank you for your trust and partnership throughout this transformative year. I look forward to what we will accomplish together in 2026 and extend my warmest wishes for the festive season.

H.E. Calvin St. Juste

Executive Chairman, St. Kitts and Nevis CIU Board of Governors

